Q+A

SAYING IT LIKE IT IS

Actor **Saif Ali Khan** who has never been shy of trying new things now lends his voice to a Marvel character in a new Audible podcast

Q. Is working on a podcast series akin to dubbing for a film or voicing an animated film?
It's a bit of both. Dubbing is about recreating the same emotion. Sometimes people find it undesirable because you have to go back and relive it. I like it because I feel I can improve on things. In fact, after doing Marvel's *Wastelanders*, I went in to dub *Adipurush*, and the makers were quite impressed, saying my dubbing was fast and expressive. *Wastelanders* became a kind of audio workout.

Q. Of the umpteen characters in the Marvelverse, would you have picked Star-Lord to play?
Never. I'd like to play Wolverine or the Human Torch from the Fantastic Four. But I liked the idea of playing an intergalactic smuggler with a great sense of humour. He is retro in that he listens to music on his Walkman and likes 1980s music. I have recently taken to the '80s myself. It was a time of excess, sure, but it was a cool decade.

Q. You are an avid reader. Do you like audio books?
I have never listened to a book on audio. I like listening to Stephen Fry's ruminations on various things. He did a very interesting show called *The Seven Deadly Sins*. My middle son [Taimur] listens to some stories. When I was a kid, my mum [Sharmila Tagore] had a record of Bing Cosby narrating *The Adventures of Tom Sawyer*. Audio has always been an effective medium, but I never thought I'd be doing it.

Q. You were one of the first to take to OTT. Do you see original podcasts series attracting a big following?
I think it will. It is a communal thing. You can listen to it on the move, it can even bond a group of kids. Audio is so descriptive. So saying yes to Audible required very little thought. They are doing it right by spending money on good talent–writing and voice artistes. When I did *Sacred Games* with Netflix, I was never under the impression that it was a comedown. It was the first time I was in a writing environment where people were trying to be as clever as possible and not trying to keep it 'simple'.

with Suhani Singh

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

